

I'll be honest—I love a nice long relaxing shower, but when you really stop to think about it, it's crazy how much water you waste for the sake of a spa-like experience. Try to shorten the length of your showers, and/or turn the water off to suds up with shampoo, conditioner, and body wash. And if you always shave in the shower, try filling the sink with warm water and shave from there instead.

Something else you shouldn't overlook is the age and efficiency of your showerhead. A conventional showerhead actually pours out three to five gallons *per minute*, while a more efficient low-flow head only uses two. If you take a fifteen to twenty minute shower, this means you could save fifteen to sixty gallons, just by changing your showerhead!

Here's a real life example:

When I crunched the numbers of our latest water bill from New York, we pay an approximate \$.0112 per gallon of water, so just over a penny. For a 15-minute shower using 5 gallons per minute, that one shower costs \$.84 for just one person.

However, if you switch to a low-flow showerhead and take a 15-minute shower using 2 gallons per minute, that one shower costs \$.34 for just one person—a \$.50 difference.

That might not sound like much, but let's say that one person takes a shower every single day for a year. You pay only \$124.10 for that shower as opposed to \$306.60—a **\$182.50 difference for one person!** Think about how much you could save with a family of four, or if you could cut that shower down to 10 minutes, let alone 5.⁵

For those of you who love lounging in the tub, try to limit this as only a special treat, or don't fill the tub all the way. Half is plenty to enjoy a relaxing soak, and even less can be used for splashing kiddos.

READER TIP:

My two youngest bathe together, and for my older two I bought a timer from Dollar Tree to set for seven minutes for their showers. When it